

Needs & Audience Analysis

Digital Literacy Fundamentals — A Course for First-Time Device Users Preparing for Reentry

1. Relationship to the Existing Digital-Literacy Profile

This course serves the population already defined in the Digital Literacy On-Ramp analysis on file: adults in jails and prisons using a shared or personal tablet, including long-sentence learners whose last exposure to consumer technology predates touchscreens or smartphones entirely, learners with variable formal education, and learners managing the psychological weight of incarceration itself. That analysis's Learner Population, Key Constraints, Functional Needs, and Psychological & Trauma-Informed Needs sections apply here without modification and are not restated in full below.

What's added here is specific to Digital Literacy Fundamentals as a standalone, named vocational/reentry course rather than a short onboarding step: this course exists because a learner will need these skills for something — a job application, a resume, an interview — not just to operate the learning platform itself. That external stake changes two things the general on-ramp analysis didn't have to account for: urgency, and consequence of failure outside the course.

2. What's New: Reentry Timing Pressure

The general on-ramp assumes a learner moving through platform onboarding at their own pace, with no external clock. A learner approaching release, or already released and job-searching, doesn't have that luxury.

Factor	General On-Ramp Assumption	Reentry-Specific Reality
Timeline	Learner can complete onboarding whenever, no deadline pressure.	A learner may take this course weeks or days before release, or after release while actively job-searching — a missed interview because they couldn't operate a laptop is a real, immediate cost.
Stakes of a skill gap	Not knowing how to use a laptop is a platform-access barrier.	Not knowing how to use a laptop is now also an employment barrier — applications, onboarding paperwork, and interviews increasingly assume basic digital fluency as an unstated qualification.
Motivation framing	Framed as removing a barrier to using the learning platform.	Can be framed as a direct, visible step toward a concrete outcome the learner already wants (a job) — a stronger motivational hook, and one the course's Orientation lesson should use explicitly.

This doesn't change the course's internal pacing model — it stays self-paced and untimed, consistent with the trauma-informed principle already established (no punitive framing for slowness). It changes the framing and stakes communicated to the learner about why the course exists, and argues for placing it early in any reentry-focused curriculum rather than treating it as optional, low-priority onboarding.

3. Learner Population — What's Specific to This Course

- Learners actively preparing for release within a defined window, for whom this course has a real external deadline even though the course itself imposes none.

- Learners already released and accessing the platform's continuation option, now needing these skills in a live job search rather than a hypothetical future one.
- Learners who may have used a feature phone or a basic terminal in a work-release or facility job program, but never a modern laptop with a full OS, mouse, and multi-window interface — a partial-familiarity case the general on-ramp doesn't specifically address.

4. Functional Needs Specific to This Course

- Recognize and operate the four core input domains — mouse, keyboard, windows, desktop — well enough to transfer that skill to a real, physical laptop the learner has not yet touched. Transfer outside the platform is the entire point of the course, not just competence inside it.
- Understand explicitly, not just implicitly, that each simulated action maps to a real device — the course has to name the transfer, not assume the learner will infer it (see Task & Content Analysis, Section 4).
- Build baseline confidence before ever encountering a real laptop unsupervised — for a reentry learner, the first real laptop they touch may be at a library, a job center, or an interview, with no one available to help if they get stuck.

5. Psychological & Trauma-Informed Needs Specific to This Course

- Avoid framing built around deficit or catching up (“you're behind on technology”) — dignity in the framing of “new to this” applies with extra weight here, since the external stakes (employment) could tip this into shame-based motivation if not handled carefully.
- No visible skill-gap disclosure required — a learner should never have to admit “I don't know how to use a laptop” to another person as a condition of accessing this course.
- Confidence-building sequencing: because failure here has a real external cost (unlike a creative-writing journal prompt), early wins matter more. The course front-loads the lowest-risk, most immediately masterable skills before harder discrimination tasks — see Content Outline/Blueprint, Section 2, for the resulting lesson order.

6. Design Implications Specific to This Course

- Every simulated interaction in the capstone lesson must be explicitly labeled with its real-world equivalent term (click, double-click, drag, minimize) — the learner needs the vocabulary as much as the motor pattern, since job postings and interview instructions will use that vocabulary and assume it's already known.
- Sequence lessons from lowest to highest motor/cognitive demand, not by arbitrary topic grouping — see Task & Content Analysis, Section 3, for the prerequisite hierarchy this sequencing is built from.
- Frame the course's Orientation lesson around the concrete outcome (a job application, an interview) rather than the abstract skill (“learn to use a laptop”) — consistent with Andragogy's relevance principle already in use across the other courses in this portfolio.

7. Open Questions / Assumptions to Validate

- Whether Edovo's platform already surfaces job-search or reentry-employment content this course should sequence ahead of or alongside — not verified, would need product/content-team input.
- Actual timing patterns: how close to release learners typically engage with vocational content, which would sharpen the urgency framing in Section 2 beyond a general assumption.
- Whether facility programs already expose some learners to a basic terminal or kiosk, which would mean the “partial familiarity” case in Section 3 is more common than assumed and worth a distinct on-ramp path rather than one-size-fits-all sequencing.